

PROPERTIES OF METALS AND NON-METALS

Metals

- Capable of being highly polished (they have a lustre or are shiny when cut).
- Good conductors of heat and electricity.
- All are solid at room temperature (except for mercury).
- Can be hammered into thin sheets (malleable) and stretched into wires (ductile).
- Found on the **left-hand side** of the Periodic Table.

Non-metals

- Usually don't shine when polished.
- Poor conductors of electricity (except carbon), and heat.
- Exist as solids, liquids and gases at room temperature.
- Those that are solid are brittle (they shatter).
- Found on the **right-hand side** of the Periodic Table.



Metalloids

- Have properties of both metals and non-metals.
- Only 8 elements belong to this group.
- Found between the metals and non-metals towards the **right-hand side** of the Periodic Table.